

MANDAR DEODHAR



Combating terrorists who were armed with the state-of-the-art automatic weapons with a carbine was no mean feat, but Nalavade took on the challenge. While the sight of dead bodies was none too pleasant, Nalavade opened fire. "I fired three shots from my carbine. However, when I set out to fire the fourth time, the bullet got twisted and stuck in the carbine. My weapon was now useless," says Nalavade. "I repaired my gun and returned to the spot. Unfortunately, they had escaped," adds the constable whose shots made one of the terrorists drop his bags.

Then, with help of CST workers, Nalavade carted dead bodies and the injured to St. George Hospital. When he returned, the local police was bringing the situation under control.

VINOD Y. SHINDE, 33

Railway Police Constable **LOCATION:** CST

"I ran back to get my weapon but they had moved closer to us"

Railway Police Constable Vinod Shinde regrets that he did not get a chance to fight the terrorists who attacked the CST. When all officers ran to ascertain the reason behind the sound of firing, Shinde rushed out of the police station with them. What he saw was two terrorists firing indiscriminately at people near the platform. "I rushed back to the post and would have had to go to the weapons room to get my arms. But by then, they had moved closer to us. So I couldn't get out immediately," recalls Shinde. So, he began helping the injured. He carried a hurt assistant sub-inspector and a home guard into the chowkie and took the injured and bodies of the dead to the nearby St. George Hospital. "As a precautionary measure we divided ourselves into groups of four to inspect the station thoroughly," he says. Later, he helped the police in collecting the abandoned luggage and deposited them at the railway office. He may not have been involved in the actual combat, but Shinde, who left for home only at 6 a.m. the next day, definitely emerged a hero.



AP PHOTO/RAJANISH KAKADE



ARUN JADHAV, 40

Constable **LOCATION:** In car with Hemant Karkare and Ashok Kamte

"We were told that a red car was approaching us"

When Constable Arun Jadhav rushed to Cama Hospital along with Vijay Salaskar, the terrorists were already firing from the hospital terrace. Karkare, Kamte and Salaskar, a sharpshooter, exchanged a few words and got into Karkare's Qualis, moving into the hospital lane. Salaskar took charge of the wheel, while Kamte sat beside him. In the back seat were Karkare and Jadhav. "We got a feed from the control room saying that a red car was approaching us," recounts Jadhav. Within seconds, the terrorists opened fire at the Qualis. While Kamte was instantly shot dead, Salaskar and Karkare were seriously injured. Jadhav aimed a carbine in the direction of the terrorists but a bullet hit his hand and he collapsed on the car floor. "The next thing I saw was that the terrorists dragged out the officers and threw them on the road," he says. He continued sitting in the car even though the terrorists believed he was dead. The firing continued from Metro to Vidhan Bhavan. At Mantralaya, the terrorists discovered they had a flat tyre. They hijacked a Skoda and sped off. Jadhav managed to call the control room, which alerted the D.B. Marg Police, who soon nabbed Kasab.